

## SEMESTER S3

### THEORY OF COMPUTATION

(Common to CS/CA/CM/CD/CN/CC)

|                                            |                 |                    |               |
|--------------------------------------------|-----------------|--------------------|---------------|
| <b>Course Code</b>                         | <b>PCCST302</b> | <b>CIE Marks</b>   | 40            |
| <b>Teaching Hours/Week<br/>(L: T:P: R)</b> | 3:1:0:0         | <b>ESE Marks</b>   | 60            |
| <b>Credits</b>                             | 4               | <b>Exam Hours</b>  | 2 Hrs 30 Mins |
| <b>Prerequisites (if any)</b>              | PCCST205        | <b>Course Type</b> | Theory        |

#### Course Objectives:

1. To introduce the concept of formal languages.
2. To discuss the Chomsky classification of formal languages with a discussion on grammar and automata for regular, context-free, context-sensitive, and unrestricted languages.
3. To discuss the notions of decidability and the halting problem.

### SYLLABUS

| <b>Module No.</b> | <b>Syllabus Description</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | <b>Contact Hours</b> |
|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| <b>1</b>          | <p><b>Foundations (Linz, Hopcroft)</b></p> <p>Motivation for studying computability, need for mathematical modeling - automata, Introducing automata through simple models - On/Off switch, coffee vending machine. Three basic concepts: Alphabet, Strings, and Languages</p> <p><b>Finite Automata (Linz, Hopcroft)</b></p> <p>Formal definition of a finite automaton, Deterministic Finite Automata (DFA), Regular languages, Nondeterminism (guess and verify paradigm), Formal definition of a nondeterministic finite automaton, NFA with epsilon transitions, Eliminating epsilon transitions (Proof not expected), Equivalence of NFAs and DFAs (Proof not expected) - The Subset Construction. DFA State Minimization, Applications of finite automata - text search, keyword recognition</p> | <b>11</b>            |
| <b>2</b>          | <p><b>Regular Expressions (Linz)</b></p> <p>The formal definition of a regular expression, Building Regular Expressions, Equivalence with finite automata (Proof not expected) -</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                      |

|   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |    |
|---|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|
|   | <p>Converting FA to Regular Expressions, Converting Regular Expressions to FA, Pattern Matching and Regular Expressions, Regular grammar, Equivalence with FA - Conversion in both directions</p> <p><b>Properties of Regular Languages (Linz)</b></p> <p>Closure and Decision Properties of Regular Languages (with proofs), The Pumping Lemma for Regular Languages (with formal proof), Pumping lemma as a tool to prove non regularity of languages</p> <p><b>Context-Free Grammars and Applications (Linz)</b></p> <p>Formal definition of a context-free grammar, Designing context-free grammars, Leftmost and Rightmost Derivations Using a Grammar, Parse Trees, Ambiguous Grammars, Resolving ambiguity, Inherent ambiguity, CFGs, and programming languages</p> | 11 |
| 3 | <p><b>Pushdown Automata (Linz)</b></p> <p>Formal definition of a pushdown automaton, DPDA and NPDA, Examples of pushdown automata</p> <p>Equivalence NPDAs and CFGs (Proof not expected) - conversions in both directions</p> <p><b>Simplification of Context-Free Languages (Linz)</b></p> <p>Elimination of useless symbols and productions, Eliminating epsilon productions, Eliminating unit productions, Chomsky normal form, Greibach normal form,</p> <p><b>Properties of Context-Free Languages (Linz)</b></p> <p>The Pumping Lemma for Context-Free Languages (with formal proof), Closure and Decision Properties of Context-Free Languages (with formal proofs)</p>                                                                                             | 11 |
| 4 | <p><b>Turing Machines (Kozen)</b></p> <p>The formal definition of a Turing machine, Examples of Turing machines - Turing machines as language acceptors, Turing machines as computers of functions, Variants of Turing Machines (Proofs for equivalence with basic model not expected), Recursive and recursively enumerable languages</p> <p>Chomskian hierarchy, Linear bounded automaton as a restricted TM.</p> <p><b>Computability (Kozen)</b></p> <p>Church Turing thesis, Encoding of TMs, Universal Machine and Diagonalization, Reductions, Decidable and Undecidable Problems, Halting problem, Post Correspondence Problem and the proofs for their undecidability.</p>                                                                                         | 11 |

**Course Assessment Method**  
**(CIE: 40 marks, ESE: 60 marks)**  
**Continuous Internal Evaluation Marks (CIE):**

| Attendance | Assignment/<br>Microproject | Internal<br>Examination-1<br>(Written) | Internal<br>Examination- 2<br>(Written ) | Total |
|------------|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|-------|
| 5          | 15                          | 10                                     | 10                                       | 40    |

**End Semester Examination Marks (ESE)**

*In Part A, all questions need to be answered and in Part B, each student can choose any one full question out of two questions*

| Part A                                                                                                                                                                                         | Part B                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Total     |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>2 Questions from each module.</li> <li>Total of 8 Questions, each carrying 3 marks</li> </ul> <p style="text-align: center;"><b>(8x3 =24 marks)</b></p> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Each question carries 9 marks.</li> <li>Two questions will be given from each module, out of which 1 question should be answered.</li> <li>Each question can have a maximum of 3 subdivisions.</li> </ul> <p style="text-align: center;"><b>(4x9 = 36 marks)</b></p> | <b>60</b> |

**Course Outcomes (COs)**

At the end of the course students should be able to:

| Course Outcome |                                                                                                      | Bloom's<br>Knowledge<br>Level (KL) |
|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| <b>CO1</b>     | Classify formal languages into regular, context-free, context-sensitive, and unrestricted languages. | <b>K2</b>                          |
| <b>CO2</b>     | Develop finite state automata, regular grammar, and regular expression.                              | <b>K3</b>                          |
| <b>CO3</b>     | Model push-down automata and context-free grammar representations for context-free languages.        | <b>K3</b>                          |
| <b>CO4</b>     | Construct Turing Machines to accept recursive and recursively enumerable languages.                  | <b>K3</b>                          |
| <b>CO5</b>     | Describe the notions of decidability and undecidability of problems, the Halting problem.            | <b>K2</b>                          |

Note: K1- Remember, K2- Understand, K3- Apply, K4- Analyse, K5- Evaluate, K6- Create

**CO-PO Mapping Table (Mapping of Course Outcomes to Program Outcomes)**

|            | PO1 | PO2 | PO3 | PO4 | PO5 | PO6 | PO7 | PO8 | PO9 | PO10 | PO11 | PO12 |
|------------|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|------|------|------|
| <b>CO1</b> | 3   | 3   | 3   | 3   |     |     |     |     |     |      |      | 3    |
| <b>CO2</b> | 3   | 3   | 3   | 3   |     |     |     |     |     |      |      | 3    |
| <b>CO3</b> | 3   | 3   | 3   | 3   |     |     |     |     |     |      |      | 3    |
| <b>CO4</b> | 3   | 3   | 3   | 3   |     |     |     |     |     |      |      | 3    |
| <b>CO5</b> | 3   | 3   | 3   | 3   |     |     |     |     |     |      |      | 3    |

Note: 1: Slight (Low), 2: Moderate (Medium), 3: Substantial (High), -: No Correlation

| <b>Text Books</b> |                                                           |                                   |                                    |                         |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| <b>Sl. No</b>     | <b>Title of the Book</b>                                  | <b>Name of the Author/s</b>       | <b>Name of the Publisher</b>       | <b>Edition and Year</b> |
| 1                 | An Introduction to Formal Languages and Automata          | Peter Linz and Susan H. Rodger    | Jones and Bartlett Publishers, Inc | 7/e, 2022               |
| 2                 | Introduction to Automata Theory Languages And Computation | John E.Hopcroft, Jeffrey D.Ullman | Rainbow Book Distributions         | 3/e, 2015               |
| 3                 | Automata and Computability                                | Dexter C. Kozen                   | Springer                           | 1/e,2007                |

| <b>Reference Books</b> |                                                         |                                        |                               |                         |
|------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------|
| <b>Sl. No</b>          | <b>Title of the Book</b>                                | <b>Name of the Author/s</b>            | <b>Name of the Publisher</b>  | <b>Edition and Year</b> |
| 1                      | Introduction to the Theory of Computation               | Michael Sipser                         | Cengage India Private Limited | 3/e, 2014               |
| 2                      | Introduction to Languages and the Theory of Computation | John C Martin                          | McGraw-Hill Education         | 4/e, 2010               |
| 3                      | Theory of Computation: A Problem-Solving Approach       | Kavi Mahesh                            | Wiley                         | 1/e, 2012               |
| 4                      | Elements of the Theory of Computation                   | Harry R. Lewis, Christos Papadimitriou | Pearson Education             | 2/e, 2015               |

| Video Links (NPTEL, SWAYAM...) |                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Module No.                     | Link ID                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 1                              | <a href="https://archive.nptel.ac.in/courses/106/104/106104148/">https://archive.nptel.ac.in/courses/106/104/106104148/</a><br><a href="https://nptel.ac.in/courses/106106049">https://nptel.ac.in/courses/106106049</a> |
| 2                              | <a href="https://archive.nptel.ac.in/courses/106/104/106104148/">https://archive.nptel.ac.in/courses/106/104/106104148/</a><br><a href="https://nptel.ac.in/courses/106106049">https://nptel.ac.in/courses/106106049</a> |
| 3                              | <a href="https://archive.nptel.ac.in/courses/106/104/106104148/">https://archive.nptel.ac.in/courses/106/104/106104148/</a><br><a href="https://nptel.ac.in/courses/106106049">https://nptel.ac.in/courses/106106049</a> |
| 4                              | <a href="https://archive.nptel.ac.in/courses/106/104/106104148/">https://archive.nptel.ac.in/courses/106/104/106104148/</a><br><a href="https://nptel.ac.in/courses/106106049">https://nptel.ac.in/courses/106106049</a> |